

1980–1989

MUST-HAVE LABELS

After the anti-fashion 1970s, when casual and street clothes gained prominence, it seemed inevitable that the role of the designer would stage a revival. During the 1980s not only was interest focused increasingly on high fashion, but also on the designer as a personality. The names of some designers became synonymous with their iconic pieces: Italian Gianni Versace for his perfectly fitting cocktail dresses in metallic colours; Frenchmen Christian Lacroix for his puffball skirt and rose prints, and Jean Paul Gaultier for his cone bra; and the German Karl Lagerfeld for the classic Chanel suit updated in jewel colours with a flamboyant dash. Some of the influential 1980s designers continue to the present day.



1982

1983

History After the furore of punk designs Vivienne Westwood produced a number of inventive collections in the early 1980s that established her as a mainstream force. This piece is part of her *Savage* collection.

New look French designer Thierry Mugler created a new way of dressing for women in the 1980s, using a strict cut and precision lines to enhance, and contrast with, natural body curves. This nautical look is from Spring/Summer 1983.



1985

1987

Evening fantasy In the “greedy” 1980s most women could not afford luxury brands, but there were many mid-priced designers creating stylish clothes. Vera Mont was one such British label, which focused on party dresses and bridal wear.

Body-conscious engineering Tunisian-born Azzedine Alaïa was one of the most influential designers of the 1980s. Women loved his form-fitting clothes because they were a kind of internal corset to hold and flatter the wearer.



Extravagant couture Despite being the youngest couturier in 1986, Lacroix's look drew on old-world luxury. His designs brimmed with historical references, and were executed with gorgeous fabrics and a sense of coquettish charm.